

Title:

Authors: Sally Way¹, Greg Baker^{2,3}, Lisa Diva¹, Georgina Schlub¹

Affiliations:

1. Graduate School of Health – Faculty of Health, University of Technology Sydney, Sydney NSW, Australia
2. College of Engineering, Computing and Cybernetics, Australian National University, Canberra, ACT, Australia
3. Faculty of Science and Engineering, Macquarie University, Sydney, NSW, Australia

Commented [GS1]: brief, informative, of 150 characters (including spaces) or less and should not make a statement or conclusion brief, informative, of 150 characters (including spaces) or less and should not make a statement or conclusion

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Abstract

Prompt for Sally:

1. *Why is language describing race, ethnicity and ancestry controversial or important in human genetics?*
2. *What exactly did you measure, across what literature and why?*
3. *What type of analysis, time span, journals and keywords?*
4. *What happened to “Caucasian”, “white” and “European ancestry” over time*
5. *Why should ESHG readers (researchers, editors and reviewers) care (i.e., implications!)*

Commented [GS3]: Articles must be prepared with an unstructured abstract designed to summarise the essential features of the paper in a logical and concise sequence. 3-6 keywords should also be included on this page. 250 words max

Introduction

Prompt for Sally:

Paragraph 1- the problem: What is the problem with how race, ethnicity and ancestry are described in human genetics research today, could briefly reference things like inconsistency, historical baggage, editorial concern, scientific imprecision (1-2 citations)

Paragraph 2 – why “Caucasian” matters specifically: why is “Caucasian” uniquely contentious compared to other descriptors?

Paragraph 3 – existing guidance and what we still don't know: What guidance already exists (JAMA, Cell genomics, ASHG etc) and what empirical evidence is missing? Explicitly state the gap like this... “Despite increasing guidance, little is known about how terminology has actually changed across journals over time...”

Paragraph 4 study and contribution: Something like “In this study, we examine temporal trends in the used of the terms “Caucasian”, “white” and “European ancestry” across XX(number) journals publishing human genetics research over the last century. Using corpus-based word frequency analysis we assess how terminology has evolved in relation to scientific, social and editorial developments in the study of human genetics” ...End with a couple of research questions

Commented [GS4]: Main body of text (excluding abstract, references and tables/figures) not to exceed 4,000 words; Max 4 tables and 4 figures; Max 50 references

Introduction: should assume that the reader is knowledgeable in the field and should therefore be as brief as possible but can include a short historical review where desirable.

700-900 words max

Materials and Methods

Corpus construction

What journals, years, where and why these?

Data extraction

Title/abstract analysis

Data validation

How did we ensure accuracy, particularly for the word “white” which is ambiguous. Include the LLM stuff and manual checking and limitations.

Data analysis

Things like article counts, five year moving averages, and the website where things are being hosted.

Commented [GS5]: This section should contain sufficient detail, so that all experimental procedures can be reproduced, and include references.

Commented [GS6]: These sub sections are just suggestions to get you off the ground :) Please feel free to change

Commented [GS7]: Greg to contribute here

Commented [GS8]: Greg to contribute here

Results

Short orienting paragraph that includes details like article count, date range, scope

Full text trends

Data direction, peaks, relative change, concordance, contrast between terms

Method concordance

Should we add a section about the methodological contribution – validity of title/abstract analysis, could be good for editors.

Commented [GS9]: The Results section should briefly present the experimental data in text, tables or figures. Tables and figures should not be described extensively in the text.

Commented [GS10]: Like with the methods section, these sub headings are just suggestions :)

Discussion

Prompt for Sally:

Paragraph 1- summary of main findings: what did we find?

Possible section 1: “Decline of “Caucasian” – discuss timing, alignment with genomics era and editorial guidance, not every historical event

Possible section 2: Moving towards “white” – what does the rise of “white” suggest about how the field is replacing rather than abandoning racial descriptors? Perhaps link to 2020 social context, editorial responses?

Possible section 3: Limited uptake of “European Ancestry”

Possible section 4: Implications – what are they, and what should researchers, reviewers and editors do differently as a result of these findings (important!)

Section 5: Limitations – sampling bias, abstract availability, correlational nature

Section 6: Conclusion- what single idea do you want the reader to remember? Cautious optimism?

Commented [GS11]: The Discussion should focus on the interpretation and the significance of the findings with concise objective comments that describe their relation to other work in the area. It should not repeat information in the results. The final paragraph should highlight the main conclusion(s), and provide some indication of the direction future research should take.

Data availability statement

Code availability

References

Acknowledgements

Author contribution statement

Funding

Financial assistance was not received in support of the study, and it was conducted as part of a Masters of Genetic Counselling dissertation

Ethics approval

Ethics approval was not required for this study

Competing interests

There are no competing financial interests in relation to the work described

Figure legends

Tables

Figures

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